

LEGION OF THE DAMNED

THE SPECTRAL HAND OF VENGEANCE

ADEPTUS ASTARTES • LEGION OF THE DAMNED • IMPERIUM

"We are not chapter. We are not Imperium. We are not living. We come when the Emperor wills, and we leave when His vengeance is satisfied." — The only words spoken by a Damned Legionnaire to a Salamanders survivor at the Battle of Sigma-Phon, 891.M40. The Legion of the Damned is a chapter no Imperial savant can locate, recruit, or even reliably name. Its Astartes appear bone-white, black-armoured, sigil-marked in cold flame; they fight beside Imperial forces at the moment of greatest need, then fade as though they were never there.

FACTION ABILITY — OATH OF MOMENT

At the start of your first Command phase, select one enemy unit. Until that unit is destroyed (or until the end of the battle), each time a model in your army makes an attack against that unit, you can re-roll a Hit roll of 1, and re-roll a Wound roll of 1.

The Damned Legionnaires bear no chapter oath but the oath taken at the moment of their summoning — whatever foe their unbidden manifestation has come to destroy.

DETACHMENT RULE — PHANTASMAL ASTARTES

Phantasmal Astartes

The Damned are not entirely real. Their armour shrugs off attacks as though the Emperor Himself stood between them and the foe — and they remember those who have killed their brothers.

Friendly **Legion of the Damned Infantry** units have the **[FEEL NO PAIN 5+]** ability against all attacks. All other friendly **Legion of the Damned** units (Vehicles, Walkers, Mounted) have the **[FEEL NO PAIN 6+]** ability against all attacks — the war-machines are real, but their Damned crews half-share the spectral half-life of the Astartes within.

In addition, each time a friendly Legion of the Damned unit makes an attack against an enemy unit that destroyed any friendly **Legion of the Damned Infantry** model earlier this battle, that attack has the **[DEVASTATING WOUNDS]** ability.

Litany of the Damned Librarians

The Damned chapter's Librarians speak with voices that the foe hears as wind in a tomb. Their psychic litanies bridge the gap between the half-real Damned and the souls of the brothers who have already fallen.

While a friendly **Legion of the Damned Librarian** model is on the battlefield, at the start of your Command phase, choose one effect. That effect remains active until the start of your next Command phase:

- **Echo of the Fallen** — Each time a friendly Legion of the Damned Infantry model is destroyed while within 12" of this Librarian, return 1 lost wound to one friendly Legion of the Damned Infantry model within 9" of the Librarian.
- **Spectral Sight** — Friendly Legion of the Damned units within 12" of this Librarian ignore the Benefit of Cover when targeting enemy units.

You cannot choose the same effect in two consecutive Command phases.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

✓ **Included:** The Legion of the Damned chapter manifests its host wholesale — **every unit in this detachment is Legion of the Damned**. All canonical 10e Space Marines and Adeptus Astartes units may be taken (Battleline, Infantry, Vehicles, Walkers, Transports, Dreadnoughts, etc.); every unit gains the **LEGION OF THE DAMNED** keyword for all rules purposes. The chapter materializes its members and their war-gear — bolters, power armour, Land Raiders, Dreadnoughts — all bearing the bone-white spectral fire of the Damned. Canonical 10e **Damned Legionnaires** (Imperium Agents codex) and homebrew **Sergeant Centurius**

(sergeant_centurius_v2_card.html) are the iconic centrepiece units but no longer the only ones that benefit from the detachment rule. Generic Space Marines characters (Captain, Lieutenant, Librarian, Chaplain, Apothecary, Ancient, Techmarine, etc.) are all permitted.

X Excluded: Other named Space Marines characters (Calgar, Dante, Azrael, Sicarius, Tigurius, etc. — the Damned march under no other commander). Non-Astartes Imperial allies. Chaos / Tyranid / Necron / Eldar units.

ENHANCEMENTS

Sacred Flame 15 pts

The bearer's weapons crackle with white spectral fire that has no fuel save the foe's screams.

Weapons equipped by the bearer have the **[DEVASTATING WOUNDS]** ability. In addition, the bearer has a **5+ Feel No Pain** against Mortal Wounds.

Burning Skull 20 pts

The bearer's helmet is a death-mask of bone-white flame, and the foe's eye instinctively turns away from it.

Once per battle, in any phase other than your opponent's Charge phase, the bearer can manifest a Phantasmal Veil. Until the start of your next Command phase, all friendly **Legion of the Damned** units (and the bearer's own unit) within 9" of the bearer have the **Stealth** ability AND attacks targeting them suffer **-1 to the Wound roll**.

Vengeance Codified 15 pts

The bearer keeps a private ledger of foes who have killed her brothers. The ledger has only one column.

Each time a friendly **Legion of the Damned** unit is destroyed during the battle, the bearer permanently gains **+1 Attack** with all of their melee weapons (cumulative, no upper limit) AND a 5+ Feel No Pain against ranged attacks until the start of your next Command phase. The bearer's vengeance grows with every fall.

Phantasmal Reach 25 pts

The bearer arrives where the Emperor wills, not where the cartographer permits.

Legion of the Damned Infantry only. During deployment, place the bearer (and the Infantry unit they are leading, if any) in Strategic Reserves. From battle round **1**, this unit can arrive: set up wholly within 6" of any battlefield edge OR wholly within 6" of a friendly **Legion of the Damned Infantry** unit already on the battlefield, and more than **3"** from any enemy unit (instead of the standard 9"). The Damned arrive where they are needed.

STRATAGEMS

Damnation's Call 1 CP

Legion of the Damned — Battle Tactic Stratagem

The Damned mark a target; their bolters answer with witch-fire.

WHEN: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly **Legion of the Damned** unit has been selected to shoot.

TARGET: That unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, attacks made by bolt weapons in this unit have **+1 to the Wound roll** AND ignore the Benefit of Cover.

Phantasmal Return 2 CP

Legion of the Damned — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Damned do not die. They depart. They return when the bell next rings.

WHEN: End of any phase, if one or more friendly **Legion of the Damned Infantry** units have been completely destroyed earlier this phase.

TARGET: One destroyed Legion of the Damned Infantry unit (it was at full starting strength when it was destroyed).

EFFECT: Add a new unit of the same datasheet at the same starting strength to your Strategic Reserves. It can arrive from your next Movement phase onward, per the standard Strategic Reserves rules. Use this Stratagem only once per battle.

Pyre of the Foe 1 CP

Legion of the Damned — Battle Tactic Stratagem

Each blow lights another pyre — and each pyre lights another blow.

WHEN: The Fight phase, just after a friendly **Legion of the Damned** unit has been selected to fight.

TARGET: That unit.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, melee weapons equipped by models in this unit have the **[DEVASTATING WOUNDS]** ability. Each time a model in this unit kills an enemy model, that model gains **+1 Attack** for the rest of the phase (cumulative).

Cold Fire 1 CP

Legion of the Damned — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Damned's flesh has already burned; the bolter does not finish what fire began.

WHEN: Your opponent's Shooting phase, just after an enemy unit has selected its targets.

TARGET: One friendly **Legion of the Damned** unit selected as a target.

EFFECT: Until the end of the phase, attacks targeting your unit suffer **-1 to the Wound roll** AND your unit has the **[FEEL NO PAIN 4+]** ability (upgraded from the detachment rule's 5+).

Unbidden Manifestation 2 CP

Legion of the Damned — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

The Imperial commander does not summon the Damned. The Emperor does. They appear without warning at the moment of greatest need.

WHEN: Start of any battle round from battle round 2 onward.

TARGET: One friendly **Legion of the Damned Infantry** unit in Strategic Reserves.

EFFECT: That unit arrives this battle round and is set up wholly within 6" of any friendly Legion of the Damned unit already on the battlefield, more than 6" from any enemy unit. Use this Stratagem only once per battle.

Burning Vow 1 CP

Legion of the Damned — Epic Deed Stratagem

The Damned commander speaks the oath that summoned him. While the oath stands, no foe can lay him low.

WHEN: Your Command phase.

TARGET: One friendly **Legion of the Damned Character** model.

EFFECT: Until the start of your next Command phase, that Character (and the unit it leads, if any) re-rolls all failed Saving throws AND all failed Battle-shock tests. Use this Stratagem only once per battle.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — 2nd Ed Chapter, 10e conversion. The Legion of the Damned first appeared in 1990 (2nd Ed Codex: Ultramarines & Imperium) as the mysterious unbidden chapter that aids Imperial forces in their direst hour. They had distinct Chapter rules through 7th Ed Codex: Space Marines, were absorbed into Imperium Agents in 10e as the **Damned Legionnaires** datasheet (2024), but lost their Chapter-level identity (no detachment rule, no chapter-specific stratagems). This homebrew detachment restores that identity as a **wholesale subfaction** — modelled on how Chaos Space Marines, Salamanders, or Farsight Enclaves treat their faction-wide detachments. Every unit in the army is Legion of the Damned: the chapter manifests its host bearing the armour and arms of its members in life, Tactical Squads alongside Damned Legionnaires alongside Dreadnoughts and Land Raiders, all marked with bone-white spectral fire. The detachment rule **Phantasmal Astartes** tiers the chapter's signature half-real save: Infantry are most spectral (5+ FNP), war-machines half so (6+ FNP) reflecting their flesh-and-blood crews. The DevWounds clause triggers off any Legion of the Damned Infantry model's death — the chapter remembers all of its fallen. **Litany of the Damned** grants any LoD Librarian a free per-turn psychic-ability choice (Echo of the Fallen healing or Spectral Sight cover-ignore), restoring the Librarian's traditional role as the chapter's psychic linchpin. Manifestation-themed stratagems (Phantasmal Return, Unbidden Manifestation) and the Phantasmal Reach enhancement are restricted to **Infantry only** — war-machines do not teleport in from the Warp. Composition allows generic SM Characters (Captain, Lieutenant, Librarian, Chaplain, Apothecary, Ancient, Techmarine) but excludes other-chapter named characters: the Damned march under no other commander. Pair with `sergeant_centurius_v2_card.html` for the named character HQ.

DETACHMENT KEYWORDS

Legion of the Damned • Damned Astartes • Adeptus Astartes • Imperium